

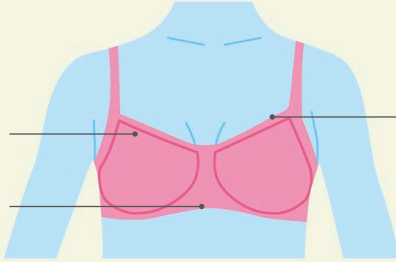
The right fit

Getting the right fit is essential for breast and back health. A bra should be so comfortable it feels like a part of the body and should give a teen confidence. It's important to keep reassessing the size of the breasts throughout life, as they can be affected by changing hormones during pregnancy and menopause.

▷ Front fitting

Cups should not feel loose or tight.

The band should fit snugly across the chest and not dig in.

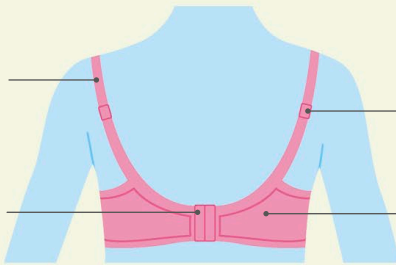


Cups should be flush against the breast, without gaps.

▷ Back fitting

The straps should be firm but not too loose or tight.

The clasp should be on the loosest setting, so it can be tightened as the bra stretches over time.

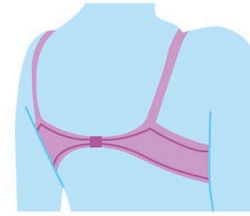


The strap length can be adjusted.

The band should sit horizontally in the middle of the back.

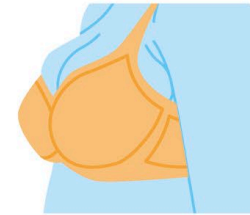
The wrong fit

Up to 70–80 percent of women are thought to wear the wrong bra size. Uncomfortable, badly fitting bras fail to give support and can cause the breasts to move or lead to backaches.



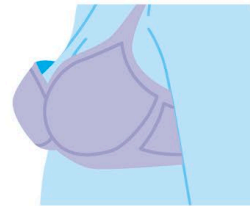
◁ Straps too tight

The strap at the back should be horizontal and not ride up. Loosen the straps to the correct length.



◁ Overspilling

The breasts should sit comfortably within the cup. A larger cup size may be needed to fully enclose the breast.



◁ Underfilling

There shouldn't be a gap between the breast and bra cup. A smaller cup size may help.

Types of bras

Bras have different purposes depending on the wearer's needs. They can also come in all sorts of styles. It can be hard to know what to choose at first, so asking for help is a great way to explore options.

Training bra or first bra

These lightweight bras are useful when breasts first start to grow, but are not yet big enough to fit a standard bra. They usually look like crop tops.



Underwire

These bras have a wire underneath to give the lining of a bra added support and structure.



Sports bra

These bras are higher cut and extra supportive, thereby minimizing discomfort caused by movement during exercise.



Soft cup bra or T-shirt bra

These bras are wire-free with soft cups. They are good for everyday use.

